SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The "My plan" column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students' hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction. Demo Session Players. Students set up and choose chord progressions.	Slides 1–8: hook, what the project is, the five steps, five words to know, steps 1 and 2 and a four-bar chord loop. Hand out the project sheet, the Chord cheat sheet and the Players sheet. Demo the three players, then check that each student has a chord progression before they leave.	Slides 1–8	p. 13, p. 14, p. 18, p. 19, p. 20, p. 22
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Customize session players. Begin arranging sections.	Slides 9–10: step 3, customize, and the same players with different settings. Students fill in the Players sheet, then start on the Arrangement plan.	Slides 9–10	p. 14, p. 15
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — arrange, add melody, refine.	Slides 11–13: step 4, how the energy changes over one minute, and the worked example on paper. Then work time on the Arrangement plan.	Slides 11–13	p. 15, p. 11, p. 12
CLASS 4		Slide 14: step 5, the melody. Hand out the Melody planner. Dedicate time to melody only, then work time.	Slide 14	p. 16
CLASS 5		Slide 15: step 6, mix. Hand out the Mix sheet. Ask each student to play their intro and then their peak, and say what changed.	Slide 15	p. 17
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix, bounce. Prepare presentations.	Slides 16–17: what to turn in and the rubric. Students bounce, name their files and post their three Padlet questions.	Slides 16–17	p. 21, p. 23
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 18–19: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate's questions. Reflection (page 24) follows the presentations.	Slides 18–19	p. 23, p. 24

THE ONE THING TO DO ON CLASS 1

Open Logic, load all three players and press play on the same four chords. Then change one setting live and ask what changed. Students need to see that the player makes the notes and they choose the sound.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days; Classes 4 and 5 have one slide each. Ask: how is your intro different from your peak?

PREVIEW

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

EXAMPLE

Worked example · an invented piece

Teacher

An **invented piece, "Porch Light", described on paper**: no audio is included. Students' projects will differ. 24 bars at 96 BPM, three Session Players, four sections (page 1 of 2).

1 · A WEAK PLAN

I will load three players and press play.

It names no chords, no settings and no sections.

2 · A CLEAR PLAN

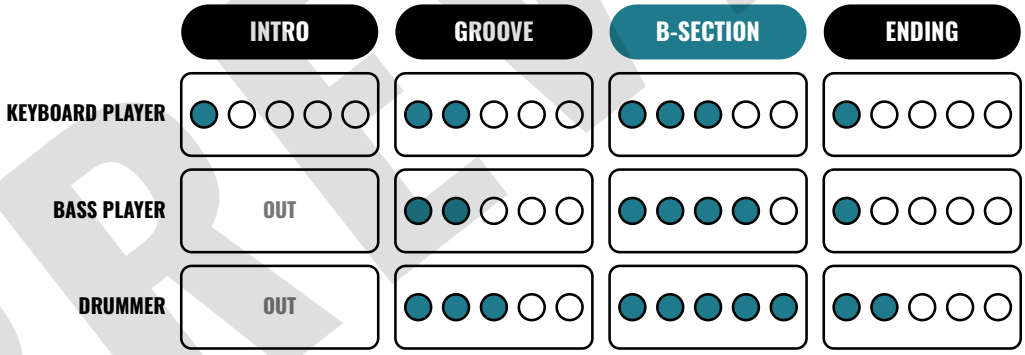
My piece is 24 bars at 96 BPM, which is 60 seconds, in the key of C. The chords are C, Am, F and G, and the B-section changes to F, G, C and Am. The Keyboard Player starts alone in the intro. The Bass Player and Drummer join at bar 5 for the groove. In the B-section the Drummer and Bass get busier and the groove changes. My melody comes in at bar 9 and uses chord tones. The ending thins out to a single C.

3 · THE CHORDS: A LOOP UNDER EVERY SECTION ·



Four bars, one chord each, then repeat. This is the loop under "Porch Light".

4 · THE SETTINGS: THE SAME PLAYERS, DIFFERENT COMPLEXITY ·



Complexity from 1 (simple) to 5 (busy), by section: an invented example

SECTION	BARS	WHAT HAPPENS
Intro	bars 1–4	Keyboard Player alone, simple (1); one chord a bar, C, Am, F, G
Groove	bars 5–12	Bass Player and Drummer join at bar 5; the same four chords twice; my melody joins at bar 9
B-section	bars 13–20	all three players busier (3, 4, 5); new chords F, G, C, Am twice; a fill at bar 12 leads in
Ending	bars 21–24	players thin out (1, 1, 2); F, G, then C for two bars; the melody ends on a held E in bar 23

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

STUDENT

Chord cheat sheet

Class 1

Name _____ Date _____

Step 2: choose a chord progression. Borrow one from a song you like or create your own. If chords intimidate you, start here. Each chord below is a major or minor chord that belongs to the key. Play one chord a bar, or two, and repeat. (This cheat sheet is the kit's own; it names no song.)

THE CHORDS IN FIVE MAJOR KEYS ·

KEY	I	II	III	IV	V	VI
C	C	Dm	Em	F	G	Am
G	G	Am	Bm	C	D	Em
D	D	Em	F#m	G	A	Bm
F	F	Gm	Am	Bb	C	Dm
A	A	Bm	C#m	D	E	F#m

Capital numerals are major chords; small numerals are minor. The same numeral is the same job in every key.

SIX COMMON PROGRESSIONS, IN EVERY KEY ·

PROGRESSION	FEEL	C	G	D	F	A
I – V – vi – IV	bright and open	C G Am F	G D Em C	D A Bm G	F C Dm Bb	A E F#m D
vi – IV – I – V	emotional, rising	Am F C G	Em C G D	Bm G D A	Dm Bb F C	F#m D A E
I – vi – IV – V	classic, nostalgic	C Am F G	G Em C D	D Bm G A	F Dm Bb C	A F#m D E
I – IV – V – I	simple and strong	C F G C	G C D G	D G A D	F Bb C F	A D E A
I – IV – vi – V	steady, warm	C F Am G	G C Em D	D G Bm A	F Bb Dm C	A D F#m E
ii – V – I	smooth, jazzy (3 chords)	Dm G C	Am D G	Em A D	Gm C F	Bm E A

TIPS

- A key you like is the one your melody sits in comfortably. Try two keys.
- Change the progression in your B-section for a lift.
- Want more? Ask a search engine or an AI chatbot for the chords to a song you like (tip 2).

CHECK

- ☐ I know the key and can name each chord.
- ☐ The chords are typed into my project, one a bar.

MY CHORDS (ONE A BAR)

My key: _____ **My progression is:** _____

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SESSION PLAYER'S STUDIO

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Session Player's Studio | Structured Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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